Developmental Tasks of Adolescence



EFN 5106

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What is adolescence?

- Adolescence: The transitional period between childhood and adulthood.
- Typically spans from ages 10-12 to 18-22.
- Marked by significant physical, cognitive, social, and emotional changes.
- A time of exploration, identity formation, and preparation for adulthood.



What are developmental tasks

- Developmental Tasks: Age-related achievements that individuals are expected to accomplish during specific periods of life.
- Successful completion leads to happiness, success in later tasks.
- Failure leads to unhappiness, difficulty with later tasks.



Key Areas of Adolescent Development

- **Physical Development:**
- **Cognitive Development:**
- **Social Development:**
- **Emotional Development:**



Small Group discussion:

List the indicators of development in the key area assigned to your group

Developmental Tasks - Physical

- **Accepting one's physique and accepting a masculine or feminine role:**
  - Adjusting to physical changes of puberty.
  - Developing a healthy body image.
  - Understanding and accepting one's sexual identity.
- **Challenges:** Body image issues, eating disorders, early or late maturation.
- **Support:** Education, positive role models, open communication.



Developmental Tasks - Cognitive

- **Developing abstract thinking skills:**
  - Moving beyond concrete operational thought.
  - Engaging in hypothetical reasoning and problem-solving.
  - Developing critical thinking skills.
- **Developing a moral compass**
- **Challenges:** Difficulty with abstract concepts, lack of motivation, educational disparities.
- **Support:** Challenging curriculum, opportunities for critical thinking, encouragement of intellectual curiosity.



Developmental Tasks – Socio-emotional (relationships)

- **Achieving new and more mature relations with age-mates of both sexes:**
  - Forming meaningful friendships and romantic relationships.
  - Learning social skills and navigating social situations.
  - Individuation
  - Developing empathy and understanding of others.
- **Renegotiating relationships with adults**
- **Challenges:** Peer pressure, social exclusion, bullying, relationship conflicts, adultism.
- **Support:** Social skills training, conflict resolution skills, promoting inclusivity.



Developmental Tasks – Socio-emotional (roles)

- **Achieving a socially acceptable masculine or feminine social role:**
  - Understanding and internalizing gender roles.
  - Developing a sense of self that aligns with one's gender identity.
- **Adopting socially acceptable behaviours**
- **Challenges:** Poor role models, Gender stereotypes, societal expectations, discrimination, negative peer influence.
- **Support:** Positive role modeling, Gender-affirming environments, challenging stereotypes, promoting equality



Understanding Adolescent challenges

- Difficult and confusing * Hormonal *Easily misunderstood



Questions Comments Discussion

